



REPTILES

Number of species: 10,038

KEY FEATURES



Lay eggs



Some give birth to live young



Scaly skin



Cold-blooded

Reptiles evolved from amphibians around 320 million years ago when the climate turned hot and dry. A protective shell around the egg meant that they could be laid on land, which allowed reptiles to colonize new areas. Being cold-blooded, they need the heat of the Sun to raise their body temperature in the morning. Once they start moving, their muscles produce heat and they seek shade if they become too hot.

TURTLE



CHAMELEON

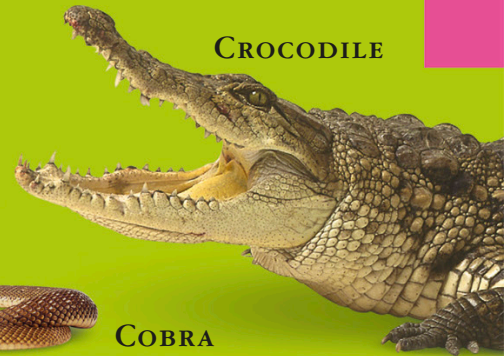


BASILISK LIZARD



COBRA

CROCODILE



AMPHIBIANS

Number of species: 7,302

KEY FEATURES



Lay eggs



Moist skin



Spend part of life cycle in water



Cold-blooded

Amphibians live close to fresh water. Their eggs have no shells, so laying them in water stops them from drying out while they develop. They start life as tadpoles, breathing through gills and with a tail to help them swim. As they turn into adults they develop lungs and lose their tail so that they can live on land. Most need a damp environment to keep their skin moist, since they also breathe through their skin.

I come complete with a breathable outer layer.

POISON-DART FROG



HORNED FROG



SALAMANDER



AXOLOTL



TOAD



FISH

Number of species: 32,900

KEY FEATURES



Lay eggs



Some give birth to live young



Live in water



Most are cold-blooded

Fish were the first animals to develop a backbone. They live in water and take in oxygen through a pair of gills just behind the head. Fish have a streamlined shape and smooth skin or scales that let them slip easily through the water. They steer using fins and are powered by a muscular tail. Fast swimmers, such as tuna, swordfish, and some sharks, have a special circulation system that keeps their brains and muscles warm. Species such as eels can even live on the land for short periods of time.

Dinner time!

GOLDFISH



ANGELFISH



LIONFISH



EEL



SHARK

